

BEFORE

A desire to return to a purer, more traditional form of Islam (the Muslim faith) grew among Muslims tired of westernizing influences on their way of life.

DEOBANDI ISLAMIC MOVEMENT

Al Imam Mohammad Quasim Nanotwi established the **Deoband Madrassa** (religious school) in British-ruled India in 1866. The school taught **Shariah law** (see right) and aimed to **purify Islam** of “un-Islamic” practices, particularly the influences of British colonial culture. After the partition of India ◀◀ 410–11 in 1947, the Deoband Madrassa closed, and new madrassas in Pakistan were opened.

THE MUSLIM BROTHERHOOD

Founded by **Hasan al-Banna** in Egypt in 1928, the Muslim Brotherhood agitated for the introduction of Shariah law. The Brothers’ leader bemoaned the sickness of the *Ummah*, or larger Muslim community, and gave the Brothers *jihadia* (military training) to help the “struggle in the

way of God” against them. The Brotherhood’s activities led to their being **outlawed in Egypt**. Saudi Arabia gave refuge to Brotherhood exiles.

**COLONIAL RULE**

The Iranian Revolution

The growth of Arab nationalism in the aftermath of World War I was accompanied by the rise of “Islamism” in some Arab nations. The Islamist movement aimed to overthrow secular, pro-Western governments in the Middle East and establish Islamic states governed by Shariah law.

Many citizens of the Middle East resented the post-World War I settlements, which gave Britain and France mandates to administer their nations. Leaders of Middle Eastern countries were chosen for their willingness to collaborate with the foreign powers, and many were corrupt. Ordinary people were given few, if any, democratic rights. While Britain did provide constitutions and elected assemblies, its advisers ensured that British interests were served in any governmental decisions.

In World War I, Persia was divided between Russia and Britain, but the Russians withdrew after the Bolshevik

revolution of 1917 (see pp.376–77), leaving Britain sole rights to exploit Persian oil. In the early 1920s, the British identified Reza Khan, a senior figure in the Persian military, as a leader who could maintain the Anglo-Persian status quo. With British backing, Khan led an armed campaign to crush political opposition, declaring himself Shah of Persia in 1925.

Modernization and secularization

A fierce believer in Westernization, the Shah modernized the infrastructure of the country, which was renamed Iran in 1935. He abandoned Islamic education in favor of a more secular

**Lavish lifestyle**

Mohammed Reza Shah—shown here with his daughter, Princess Shahnaz, in 1957—had an opulent lifestyle, while the majority of his people lived in abject poverty. Cold War tensions and the need for Iranian oil led Western powers to ignore the Shah’s misrule.

